

decided to “air-drop” the cryptocurrency to Icelanders with the intent of providing 50 percent of all auroracoin in existence to residents. The hope was that such a distribution would jump-start national use of the cryptocurrency.

A key to Baldur’s plan was his access to the government’s national identification system, which led speculators to believe mistakenly that Auroracoin was sponsored by the Icelandic government. In anticipation of the airdrop, speculators bid Auroracoin’s network value over \$1 billion.⁴⁰

By the time the airdrop began on March 25, 2014, speculators had sobered somewhat, and Auroracoin was hovering just over a \$100 million network value. By the end of the month, it would be below \$20 million, as citizens receiving Auroracoin moved to sell it on exchanges to turn a profit.⁴¹ Along with the drop in price was a loss of confidence and enthusiasm for the new cryptocurrency. Few, if any, retailers were willing to accept auroracoin, and it was soon considered a “failed experiment.”⁴² Some also saw it as a scam perpetrated by its creator. To this day, auroracoin takes the cake as the cryptocurrency with the grandest plan for widespread usage throughout one country.

It continues to exist, with a handful of Icelandic developers working to revive the concept and the technology. In 2016, ads began to appear throughout Iceland’s capital city of Reykjavik heralding the return of